

Bloomberg Daily Briefing — Sunday, August 2, 2026

Middle East & Geopolitics

- **Trump holds off Iran strikes on pledge a Hormuz deal is close** — The US president said Washington will pause planned military action against Tehran after Iran and other Middle Eastern powers told him they are working on an agreement that could quickly reopen the Strait of Hormuz. The pause is conditional on a deal being reached quickly, with Israel remaining cautious and Gulf states increasingly pursuing their own security strategies.
- **Bomb kills three, injures 21 at restaurant on Moscow's Kudrinskaya Square** — Three people were killed and 21 injured after a bomb was detonated in an upscale restaurant in central Moscow on Saturday night, according to Russia's National Anti-Terrorism Committee.
- **Morocco names \$1 billion highway after Trump** — King Mohammed VI said the naming of a highway crossing into the disputed Western Sahara expresses his "deep appreciation" of the American leader.

FX & Markets

- **Yen traders brace for more intervention with US at Japan's side** — Currency markets are on high alert for further joint Tokyo-Washington operations when trading resumes Monday, after coordinated intervention last week triggered a dramatic yen rebound. Japan's Finance Minister Satsuki Katayama is set to announce as early as Monday that Japan and the US are coordinating steps to curb yen weakness.
- **Bond traders flying blind on Fed see risk yields spiral higher** — Investors including Brandywine Global and Wellington say the risk of a deeper Treasury rout is rising as Fed Chairman Kevin Warsh keeps the market in the dark about how officials will respond to the evolving economy.
- **Wall Street's favorite bet comes undone as chips whipsaw markets** — The one-way trade in semiconductor stocks that defined equity markets this year is coming unglued, triggering volatility as investors worry the fire-hose of AI spending won't continue.
- **Ugly month in emerging markets may be a taste of what's ahead** — A bruising July is testing investors' hopes for a stellar EM year, with the selloff possibly previewing further headwinds.
- **Banks offload risk from leveraged ETFs with exotic 'crash puts'** — Banks are engineering structured derivatives to hedge the risk embedded in leveraged exchange-traded funds, shifting tail risk off their own books.

Corporate & Deals

- **AstraZeneca, Bristol Myers Squibb held talks for a tie-up, FT says** — The two drugmakers have discussed a deal that would combine them into a single company, according to the Financial Times — a potential blockbuster pharma merger.
- **ANZ, NAB among banks funding Blackstone's HSBC book buy** — ANZ and National Australia Bank are among lenders bankrolling Blackstone's A\$36 billion (\$25.3 billion) purchase of HSBC's Australian retail loan portfolio, the Australian Financial Review reported.
- **Jefferies analyst slams 'simple-minded' criticism of SpaceX governance** — Investors who blacklist SpaceX over governance qualms risk depriving themselves of long-term gains, according to the bank's Aniket Shah, as the company faces its first earnings report as a public company.

Macro & Labor

- **AI is creating a two-speed jobs market in the UK** — UK employers are creating roles for experienced staff with AI skills and cutting back elsewhere, according to Indeed, as technology splits the labor market into two tracks.
- **Australia's housing market worsens with steepening falls** — Prices declined in June and July by the most since December 2022 as rising rates and tax changes hit demand.
- **Malaysia minister sees stable second-half growth** — The economy is expected to remain strong in H2 with the government maintaining stable oil supplies, Economy Minister Akmal Nasrullah said.

Technology & Policy

- **Australia expands demand that Big Tech pay for news** — The government plans to widen the scope and raise charges imposed on Big Tech to encourage deals with local media.

Politics

- **Anwar's bloc loses control of another Malaysian state** — Prime Minister Anwar Ibrahim's coalition lost a key state election to Barisan Nasional, raising doubts about his standing ahead of the next general polls.
- **UK's Burnham pledges 'relentless' focus on illegal migration** — The UK has more than doubled crime agency officers deployed to combat human smuggling over the past 18 months, stepping up the fight against the gangs behind illegal migration.

- **Republican senator calls on ex-son-in-law to resign House seat** — Senator Bernie Moreno called on Representative Max Miller to resign amid allegations of physical violence against Miller's former wife and daughter.
 - **Chicago mayor's race heats up as Democrats ready to oust Johnson** — A growing field of candidates is setting up a contentious election between progressive and moderate Democrats.
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Sources: Bloomberg Markets, Economics, Business, Politics, Technology and Wealth RSS feeds. Articles summarized are limited to RSS-lede content; full text may carry additional detail behind Bloomberg's paywall. This briefing is for informational purposes only and does not constitute investment advice.

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